Basemall Admin User's Manual

Oct 23, 2026 · @Dan

1. Getting started

The admin panel is at **https://basemall.co.ke/admin/login**. Everything in this manual is done there; you only see the menu items your role allows.

Signing in for the first time

1. Open https://basemall.co.ke/admin/login and enter your email and password.
2. You are asked to choose a new password. Use at least 10 characters that you do not use anywhere else.
3. Go to **My account** (top right, your name) and switch on **two-step sign-in**. Scan the code with an authenticator app (Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator). From then on you enter a 6-digit code after your password.

Forgotten password: on the sign-in page choose **Forgot password**. You can receive a reset link by email or a code by SMS (SMS works once the SMS gateway is on). Ask a super admin if neither arrives.

The screen

- **Left menu** (on a phone: the menu button, top left): grouped into Overview, Sales, Customer service, Finance, Marketplace, Fulfilment, Catalogue, Content & marketing, Marketing Intelligence and System.
- **Top bar:** View store (opens the shop in a new tab), My account, Sign out.
- **Green and red messages** at the top of a page confirm what you just did or say what needs correcting. Fields with a problem are outlined in red with the reason underneath.

Who can do what

Each staff member has one or more **roles**. A super admin can do everything; other roles see only their part of the menu.

Role	Typical work
Super admin	Everything, including staff, roles, settings, credentials and website updates
Manager	Orders, customers, catalogue, reports; marketing figures (view only)

Role	Typical work
Content & marketing	Pages, banners, flash sales, messages, campaigns and automations
Finance	Payments, refunds, cash on delivery, payouts
Fulfilment staff / Delivery & logistics	Preparing, dispatching and handing over orders; pickup points
Inventory clerk	Stock levels and stock movements
Support	Customers, returns, reviews, notifications

The exact permissions of every role are under **System → Roles & permissions**.

Good habits: sign out on shared computers; never share your account (every action is recorded under your name in the audit log).

2. Working with lists and tables

Every list in the admin (orders, products, customers, payments, logs) works the same way: 10 rows at a time, a search box, filters, and page links at the bottom.

- **Search as you type.** Type in the search box above the table; results update after a short pause without reloading the page. The search looks at the fields named in the box (for example order number, phone or name). Press **Esc** or the **×** to clear it.
- **Filters** sit next to the search box (status, seller, date, channel…). They combine with the search. **Reset** clears all of them.
- **Sorting:** click a column title with the ⇅ icon. Click again to reverse the order.
- **Rows per page:** choose 10, 15, 25 or 50 in the table footer. The footer also says what you are seeing, e.g. *Showing 1–10 of 248 orders*.
- **Tabs and pills** above some lists (e.g. order status, Open / Closed) switch between groups; the search keeps working inside the group.
- **Exports:** buttons such as **Export CSV** download what the list currently shows with your search and filters applied. Exports of personal data are recorded in the audit log.
- **Sharing a view:** the address bar always holds the current search, filters and page, so you can bookmark it or send the link to a colleague.

Loading and saving

- A button shows a small spinning circle and *Saving…* or *Processing…* while it works. It cannot be pressed twice, so you cannot create the same thing twice by double-clicking.

- A list being updated shows *Loading…* over the table; the rest of the page stays usable.
- A thin coloured bar at the top of the screen means the next page is on its way.
- If something cannot load (for example the connection dropped), the list shows *Unable to load records* with a **Try again** button. Nothing is lost.
- If you leave a page open for a long time and then save, you may see *Session expired*. Refresh the page and save again.

3. Dashboard and reports

The **Dashboard** (first menu item) is your work queue: it lists what needs action now, then the week's figures.

- **Work cards:** COD orders to confirm, M-Pesa payments to verify, orders needing resolution, orders to prepare, packed orders to dispatch, pickups past their hold period. Click a card to open that filtered list. You only see the cards your role can act on.
- **Figures:** booked sales today and for the last 7 days (with the change against the previous 7 days), cash received, average order, cancelled and expired orders.
- **Chart:** booked sales per day. Hover or tab onto a column for its value; a table version is underneath.
- **Low stock and recent orders** at the bottom.

Reports (Overview → Reports): sales, payments and products for a date range you choose, with CSV export. **Marketplace report** (Marketplace menu): sales, commission, refunds and balances per seller, plus reconciliation checks that confirm the seller ledger agrees with orders, refunds and payouts. Investigate any check marked *Needs attention* before paying sellers.

4. Orders and fulfilment

An order moves forward only through the buttons on its page; each step is recorded with your name, and the customer gets an SMS and/or email with the expected arrival date.

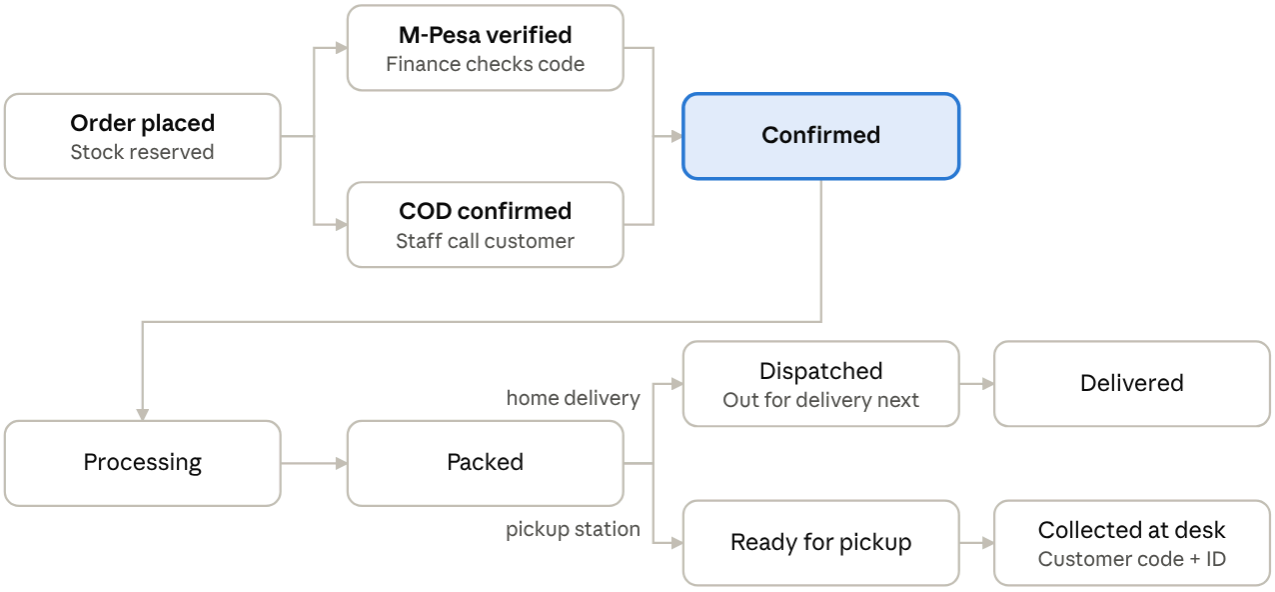
Orders (Sales → Orders). Tabs filter by status: *COD to confirm*, *Awaiting payment*, *To verify*, *Confirmed*, *Processing*, *Packed*, *Dispatched*, *Expired*, *Cancelled*. Search by order number, phone, name or email; filter by delivery or pickup and by payment status. Open an order to see its items, customer, address or pickup station, payment, stock held, history and the buttons for the next step.

How an order moves

1. **Placed.** Stock is reserved. M-Pesa orders wait for the customer's transaction code (the reservation expires after 45 minutes if unpaid); cash-on-delivery orders wait for confirmation.
2. **Confirmed.** M-Pesa: when finance verifies the payment (see section 5). COD: when you call or check the customer and press **Confirm order**.
3. **Processing → Packed.** Staff pick and pack the items. In a marketplace order each seller prepares their own part (see Seller orders below).
4. **Dispatched.** Enter the courier's delivery reference if there is one: it becomes the customer's tracking number.
5. **Out for delivery → Delivered**, or for pickup **Ready for collection → Collected** (only at the Collection desk, with the customer's code).
6. **Cancel** is available while the order has not been dispatched; it releases the reserved stock.

Every order is confirmed before it is prepared

Each step is a button on the order page; the customer is told at every step



Cancel is possible until dispatch and releases the stock. Unpaid M-Pesa orders expire after 45 minutes.

order journey · payment, preparation, delivery or pickup

No order is prepared until it is confirmed: M-Pesa orders by finance verifying the code, COD orders by staff confirming with the customer.

Seller orders (Sales → Seller orders): each seller's part of a confirmed order. *Packed* parts are waiting for Basemall to receive them from the seller; press **Received** from seller when they arrive, then dispatch with the rest of the order.

Collection desk (Sales → Collection desk): orders waiting at pickup points. Search the order number the customer gives you, press **Hand over**, enter the customer's collection code and confirm you checked their ID. For COD, record the cash at the same time. *Overdue* means waiting longer than the hold period (7 days by default); such orders can be cancelled from the order page.

Resolutions (Finance → Resolutions): orders paid after their stock reservation expired. Decide per order: Re-reserve if stock is available now, or refund.

Fulfilment menu

- **Delivery zones:** groups of counties and towns with a delivery fee, free-delivery threshold and delivery days. Every county should be in an active zone; uncovered counties are listed at the top.
- **Station applications:** businesses that applied on the public page *Become a pickup station*. Check the details (call the contact, check the location and photo), then **Approve and create station** (adjust any field first) or **Reject** with a reason. The business is told either way.
- **Pickup points:** name, code, address, opening hours, fee, whether COD is allowed, map location. **Deactivate** hides a station from checkout without losing its history.
- **Delivery settings:** which options are offered (home delivery, pickup), store-wide free delivery, notes shown at checkout, days to prepare before dispatch, and the names customers see for each order status.

5. Payments and money

Payments are manual: customers pay by M-Pesa (Till, Paybill or phone) and type the transaction code, or pay cash on delivery. Nothing counts as paid until a staff member checks it.

M-Pesa payments (Finance → M-Pesa payments)

1. Open the **To verify** tab. The oldest stock holds are at the top: verify those first, before their reservation expires.
2. For each code, find it on the M-Pesa statement of the receiving Till / Paybill / phone.
3. Type the **amount actually received** and press **Verify**. The order is confirmed and the customer is told. If the reservation had already expired, the order goes to Resolutions instead.
4. Code not found, wrong amount or reused: press **Reject** and choose the reason. The customer may submit a corrected code.

A *Short* badge means the customer claimed less than the order total. The **Decided** tab lists past decisions; search by code, order, customer or phone.

Cash on delivery (Finance → Cash on delivery): after a COD order is delivered or collected, type the amount collected and press **Record**. If it differs from the expected amount, add a note. Delivery and cash are tracked separately, so an order can be delivered but still show cash outstanding.

Refunds (Finance → Refunds): refunds created by cancellations and returns. Pay the customer (the page shows the phone the payment came from), then **Mark paid** with the method and reference. **Cancel** only if the refund is not owed.

Payment methods (Finance → Payment methods): which methods are offered, their names, order limits and the Till / Paybill / phone numbers customers pay to. Double-check every digit: customers send money there.

Seller payouts (Marketplace → Seller payouts)

1. Sellers request payouts from their available balance. They appear under **Requested**.
2. Open one and press **Approve for payment** (or **Reject payout** with a reason; the amount returns to the seller's balance).
3. Pay the seller outside the system, then **Mark as paid** with the payment method and reference.

The cards on that page show what is owed to sellers right now: pending (earned, not yet payable), payable, and requested. Each seller's full money history is under **Sellers → (seller) → Ledger**.

Commission (Marketplace → Commission): the default rate plus rates per category or per seller. A new rate applies to new orders only; existing orders keep the rate they were placed with. The **Commission earned** table counts only money actually received.

6. Customers and service

Customers (Sales → Customers): search by name, email or phone; sort by orders, booked value or join date. Opening a customer shows their orders and saved addresses. Each opening is recorded in the audit log, because it shows personal data. Guest orders are not linked to an account and appear only under Orders.

Returns (Customer service → Returns): customers request returns from their order page within the return window (7 days by default).

1. **Approve** or **Reject** the request (a rejection needs a reason).
2. When the items arrive, mark them **received and inspect each one: Pass & restock (resaleable) or Fail & write off (not resaleable)**.
3. **Complete** return: the refund is created under Finance → Refunds, and for marketplace orders the seller's earnings are reduced in proportion.

Reviews (Customer service → Reviews): reviews appear in the shop only after you press Publish. Publish genuine reviews, including critical ones; reject only abuse, spam or personal data.

Notifications (Customer service → Notifications): every email and SMS sent to customers, with secrets (codes, links) hidden. A failed email can be **Re-sent**; messages with codes or links cannot, so repeat the original action instead (for example re-issue a collection code).

Seller cases (Marketplace → Seller cases): problems with one seller's part of an order. Write to the seller and the customer from the case page, then resolve or close it. While a case is open, that seller's earnings for the part are held.

7. Catalogue and stock

Products (Catalogue → Products): search by name or SKU; filter by seller, category, status and approval.

1. **New product:** name, category, brand, description, price, the first variant (SKU, price, stock) and the maximum per order.
2. On the product page add **images** (the first is the main image; you can change it and remove others) and more **variants** (size, colour, capacity), each with its own SKU, price and stock.
3. **Active** makes the product visible in the shop; **Featured** puts it on the homepage. A product with no stock shows *Out of stock* and cannot be bought.

Product approvals (Marketplace → Product approvals): seller products wait here until approved (while the setting *Require approval before seller products go live* is on). Open a product to check photos, description and options, then **Approve**, or **Reject** with a reason the seller will see.

Categories and brands: create, rename, reorder (the *Order* number, lowest first) or hide them. A subcategory sits under its parent; hidden categories and brands disappear from the shop menus but keep their products.

Inventory (Catalogue → Inventory): stock per variant, lowest available first.

- *Available* = on hand minus reserved. Reserved units belong to placed orders and are released or used only through the order steps.
- Filter *Low stock*, *Out of stock* or *Has reservations*.
- Open a variant to **Receive** stock (deliveries), **Adjust** (damage, loss, corrections, with a reason) or **Record count (set the counted quantity after a stock-take**). Every change appears in that variant's **stock ledger** with who did it and why.

8. Sellers (marketplace)

Independent sellers sell through Basemall; Basemall's own products are the *Official Store* (the platform seller).

Seller applications (Marketplace → Seller applications): businesses and individuals apply on the public *Sell on Basemall* page and upload the documents required in Settings → Marketplace.

1. Open an application under **Waiting**. Check the business details, the categories they want to sell in and every document (documents open only for staff with seller permissions).
2. Press **Mark as under review** while you verify (for example a phone call or a visit).
3. **Approve seller** creates their store and Seller Centre account, or **Reject application** with a reason. The applicant is told either way.

Sellers (Marketplace → Sellers): search by store, address or owner email. A seller's page shows the team, payout method, products and links to the ledger.

- **Suspend** (with a reason) hides the store and its products and stops new orders; existing orders continue. **Reactivate** reverses it.
- **The Ledger link shows every amount earned, held, paid out or deducted for that seller**.

9. Content

Everything customers read in the shop, apart from products, is edited under **Content & marketing**.

- **Pages:** information and legal pages (About, Help, How to pay, Delivery & pickup, Returns, Terms, Privacy…). Built-in pages keep their address and cannot be deleted. Each save keeps the previous version, so a change can be undone from the page's history. A page can be scheduled to publish or unpublish at a set time, and shown in the Help menu.
- **Menus:** the header, footer columns and Help menu. Add, rename, reorder or hide links.
- **Homepage:** the sections of the home page (hero, categories, flash sale, top deals, recommended for you, featured…) in order. Show, hide, reorder and retitle them; set how many products each shows.
- **Banners:** the home page slides: image, title, link and an optional start and end time. Status shows *Live*, *Scheduled* or *Off*.

- **Flash sales:** a sale price on chosen variants between a start and end time, optionally with a limited quantity. Prices apply automatically on the product page, in the cart and at checkout; orders keep the price paid.
- **Messages:** the wording of every email and SMS sent to customers and sellers, grouped (orders, payments, account, marketing…). Placeholders such as `{order_number}` are filled in when sent. Some messages can be switched off per channel; messages with codes, links or money are always sent. Use the preview to see the designed email before saving.

Shop name, logo, colours, contact details and social links are under **System → Settings** (General, Contact, Social, SEO, Branding).

10. Marketing Intelligence

Marketing Intelligence measures promotions, reminds customers about abandoned carts and suggests products. Every figure comes from what actually happened in the shop; marketing goes only to customers who agreed to receive it (Kenya Data Protection Act, 2019).

Page	What you do there
Overview	Clicks, leads, carts, orders, paid sales and conversion from promotional links for a period; the funnel; suggestions from the optimization assistant; results per channel, product and recommendation placement. *How each number is measured* at the bottom explains every figure.
Campaigns & links	Create a campaign, then promotional links to share (see below). Results per campaign and link.
Leads	People who signed up for the newsletter or created an account, their stage and consent. Contact details are masked unless your role has *See and export leads*; exports are recorded.
Segments	Live customer groups (new, browsing, cart abandoners, repeat, high value, inactive, opted in…) with their members.
Abandoned carts	Reminder figures, the cart list, the reminder log and the reminder settings (see below).
Automations	Switch each automated message on or off, choose email and/or SMS, set the delays.

Page	What you do there
Recommendations	How each recommendation placement performs (shown, clicked, added to cart, ordered).
Consent	How many customers allow email, SMS and personalisation; every consent change; why messages were not sent.
Marketing settings	Tracking and privacy, recommendations, message limits and quiet hours, segment thresholds, attribution window, cart reminders.

Creating a promotional link

1. **New campaign:** name, objective, channel or platform (Facebook, WhatsApp, posters…), dates and, if you know it, the **actual cost** (needed for return on ad spend).
2. On the campaign page, **Create a promotional link**: choose where it goes (a product, category, brand, store, search or another page), the button text and optionally an active coupon. Use variants A, B… to test two wordings.
3. The **Link studio** gives you the short link (`basemall.co.ke/go/…`), ready-to-post texts for Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp and X, hashtags, share buttons, a QR code for posters and downloadable square and story images. Copy and post them yourself; the shop never posts for you.
4. Results appear on the campaign page: clicks (QR scans counted separately), visitors, carts, orders and paid sales. **Switch link off** sends anyone who opens it to the homepage.

Abandoned cart reminders

- A cart counts as abandoned when it has items, nothing happened for the set time (60 minutes by default) and no order followed.
- The customer gets an email (and SMS, once the sender ID is approved) with the items at today's prices and a personal link back to the cart. A visit postpones the reminder; an order, an emptied cart or unavailable items stop it.
- Turn it on under **Abandoned carts → Settings**: tick *Send cart reminders*, choose channels, the minutes, an optional second reminder and how long links work.
- The page shows reminders sent, delivered and failed, link clicks, recovered orders and recovered sales (and how much of that is paid).

All automations are **off** until you switch them on. Quiet hours (20:00–08:00 by default), at most 1 marketing message a day and 3 a week per customer, and **Pause all marketing messages** are in Marketing settings. Automations are sent by the scheduled task that runs every 15 minutes (section 11).

11. System administration (super admins)

Staff (System → Staff): Add staff member with name, email and role(s); they receive an email to set their own password. **Manage** changes roles, adds individual extra permissions, resets two-step sign-in or suspends the account. Give each person their own account and only the roles they need.

Roles & permissions (System → Roles & permissions): the matrix of what each role may do. Sensitive permissions (staff, roles, settings, credentials, payment numbers, commission, payouts, audit, website updates, lead contact details) are highlighted. Built-in roles cannot be deleted; you can create custom roles. You cannot change a role you hold yourself unless you are a super admin.

Audit log and Sign-in activity (System): every change in the admin with who, when, before and after, and every sign-in, failed attempt and two-step check. Neither can be edited or deleted. Search and filter by date, area, record and staff member; export to CSV.

Settings (System → Settings): grouped pages: General, Contact, Social, SEO, Checkout, Orders, Marketplace, Security, Maintenance, Branding. Notable ones:

- *Require email for guest checkout* (Checkout).
- Reservation times, collection hold days and return window (Orders).
- Seller documents required and *Require approval before seller products go live* (Marketplace).
- **Maintenance mode** closes the shop to customers with a message; staff can still sign in.
- **Transfer** exports and imports settings (never passwords).

Email & SMS (System → Email & SMS):

- **How notifications are sent:** Email only, SMS only, or both.
- **Email server** (noreply@basemall.co.ke) and **SMS gateway** (Talksasa): sender ID, on/off, API token (stored encrypted, never shown again). The SMS balance and sent/failed counts are at the top.
- **Test your setup:** send a test email and a test SMS; the result box explains any problem in plain words.
- **Delivery reports:** ask Talksasa which recent SMS reached the phones.
- **Message log:** every message sent, searchable, with Preview for emails and Re-send for failed ones.

Website updates (System → Website updates): install a new version from a .zip while the shop stays open. Upload, review the changes (blocked if a database change could alter existing data), confirm with your password. Everything is backed up first and rolled back automatically on failure; the latest update has a **Roll back** button.

Scheduled tasks (cPanel → Cron Jobs): two tasks must run on the server.

Task	How often	What breaks without it
`bin/expire-reservations.php`	Every minute	Unpaid orders keep stock reserved
`bin/marketing-run.php`	Every 15 minutes	No cart reminders or other automated messages; no nightly product suggestions

Marketing Intelligence → Automations shows when the nightly tasks last ran.

12. Checklists and troubleshooting

Every morning

- [ ] Dashboard work cards: confirm COD orders, verify M-Pesa payments (oldest first), clear Resolutions.
- [ ] Prepare and pack confirmed orders; dispatch packed ones with tracking references.
- [ ] Seller orders: receive *Packed* parts from sellers.
- [ ] Collection desk: check overdue pickups.
- [ ] Product approvals and seller applications waiting.

Every week

- [ ] Record COD cash and pay refunds due.
- [ ] Approve and pay seller payouts; check the marketplace report's reconciliation.
- [ ] Inventory: low stock and out of stock; reorder.
- [ ] Returns, reviews and seller cases still open.
- [ ] Email & SMS: failed messages and SMS balance.
- [ ] Marketing overview and abandoned-cart results.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Session expired when saving	Refresh the page and save again; a form left open for hours loses its security token.
A button stays on *Saving…*	Wait 30 seconds; if nothing happens the page shows an error. Then refresh and check whether the change was saved before trying again.

Problem	What to do
Customer says they paid but no code is on the statement	Do not verify. Ask for the M-Pesa confirmation SMS; check the right Till / Paybill / phone and date. Reject with *Code not found* if it is not there.
Payment verified after the reservation expired	The order goes to Resolutions: re-reserve if stock is available, otherwise refund.
Emails not arriving	Email & SMS → send a test email and read the result box. New senders often land in spam at first: ask customers to mark the email *Not spam*.
SMS not sending	The Talksasa sender ID must be approved and SMS switched on; the test SMS result explains the gateway's answer. Until then choose *Email only*.
Cart reminders not going out	Check that reminders are switched on, the 15-minute scheduled task runs (Automations page), it is not quiet hours, and the customer agreed to marketing.
A list shows nothing	Clear the search and filters (**Reset**).
You cannot see a menu item	Your role does not include it; ask a super admin.
The shop shows *We will be right back*	The `.htaccess` file in public_html is missing: re-upload it from the website package (cPanel File Manager → Settings → Show Hidden Files).

For anything not covered here, check the audit log for what changed and when, then contact the system administrator.